Unit -2

Landforms

Learning Objectives

- To understand the landforms produced by running water
- To describe the landforms created by glacial action
- To learn about the landforms which are produced by wind action
- To gain knowledge about land forms formed by sea waves.

Introduction

In the earlier class, we have learnt that the surface of the earth is not the same everywhere. The earth has an infinite variety of landforms named mountains, plateaus, plains, valley etc., Some parts of the lithosphere may be rugged and some flat. These landforms are a result of two processes. They are i. The Endogenic Process ii. The Exogenic Process

(i) The Endogenic Process

The ***endogenic process*** (internal process) leads to the upliftment and sinking of the earth's surface at several places.

(ii) The Exogenic Process

The ***exogenic process*** (external process) is the continuous wearing down and rebuilding of the land surface.

Gradation is the process of levelling of highlands through erosion and filling up of lowlands through deposition.

Landforms

The landscape is being continuously worn down by two processes – ***weathering and erosion***. ***Weathering*** is the breaking and falling apart into small pieces of the rocks on the earth's surface. ***Erosion*** is the wearing down of the landscape by different agents like water, wind, ice and sea waves. The eroded material is carried away by water, wind, etc. and eventually deposited. This process of erosion and deposition create different landforms on the surface of the earth.

River

The water flowing from its source to river mouth, along a definite course is called a ***River***. Rivers generally originate from a mountain or hill. The place of origin of the river is known as its ***Source***. The place where it joins a lake or sea or an ocean is known as ***River mouth***.

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